

Tor 7.0 debuts with sandbox feature

Tor, the open source browser that is popular for maintaining user anonymity, has received an update to version 7.0, which includes a sandbox feature. The new version is designed for privacy-minded folks, offering them a more secure platform to surf the Web.

The new sandbox integration hides your real IP and MAC address and even your files. The feature makes sure that the information that the Tor browser learns about your computer is limited. Moreover, it makes it harder for hackers leveraging Firefox exploits to learn about user identities. “We know there are people who try to de-anonymise Tor users by exploiting Firefox. Having the Tor browser run in a sandbox makes their life a lot harder,” Tor developer Yawning Angel wrote in a Q&A session.

Angel has been experimenting with the sandbox feature since October 2016. The feature was in the unstable and testing phase back then. However, the new release for Linux and Mac is a stable version to protect user identities.

In addition to the sandbox feature, the latest Tor version comes with Firefox 52 ESR. This new development includes tracking and fingerprinting resistance improvements such as the isolation of cookies, view-source requests and the permissions API to the first-party URL bar domain. It also includes WebGL2, the WebAudio, Social, SpeechSynthesis and Touch APIs.

With the Firefox 52 ESR addition, the latest Tor build will not work on non-SSE2-capable Windows hardware. Users also need to be using Mac OS X 10.9 or higher on Apple hardware, and use e10s on Linux and MacOS systems to begin with the sandboxing feature.

marketplace synergies, and critical mass of consulting and IP-led offerings will unlock tremendous value for all our stakeholders,” said Lavanya Rastogi, co-founder and CEO, OSSCube.

Rastogi will join Happiest Minds’ DTES business as the CEO. The Houston, Texas-based OSSCube will operate as a subsidiary of Happiest Minds. This is not the first acquisition by Happiest Minds. The Indian company has already bought out IoT services startup, Cupola Technology, this year.

With all these developments, Happiest Minds is moving forward to become the fastest Indian IT services company to reach a turnover of US\$ 100 million. The company is also in plans to go public within the next three years.

Happiest Minds presently operates in Australia, the Middle East, USA, UK and the Netherlands. It offers domain-centric solutions applying skills, IP and functional expertise in IT services, product engineering, infrastructure management and security using technologies such as Big Data analytics, Internet of Things, mobility, the cloud, and unified communications.

Microsoft’s Cognitive Toolkit 2.0 debuts with open source neural library Keras

Microsoft’s deep learning and artificial intelligence (AI) solution, Cognitive Toolkit,



has reached version 2.0. The new update is designed to handle production-grade and enterprise-grade deep learning workloads.

To enable the developments around deep learning applications, Cognitive Toolkit 2.0 supports Keras, an open source neural networking library. The latest integration helps developers receive a faster and more reliable deep learning platform without any code changes.

Chris Basolu, a partner engineering manager at Microsoft — who has been playing a key role in developing the Cognitive Toolkit builds — has tweaked the existing tools to make them accessible to enthusiasts with basic programming skills. There are also customisations available for highly-skilled developers who are all set to accelerate training for their own deep neural networks with large-sized data sets and across multiple servers.

Cognitive Toolkit 2.0 supports the latest versions of NVIDIA Deep Learning SDK and advanced GPUs like NVIDIA Volta.

In addition to the Keras support, the latest Cognitive Toolkit comes with model evaluations using Java bindings. There are also a few other tools that compress trained models in real-time. The new version is capable of compressing models even on resource-constrained devices such as smartphones and embedded hardware.

Microsoft has designed the AI solution after observing the problems faced organisations ranging from smart startups to large tech companies, government agencies and NGOs. The team, led by Basolu, aims to make the major Cognitive Toolkit features accessible to a wider audience.

Developers working with the previous release are recommended to upgrade to the latest Microsoft Cognitive Toolkit 2.0. You can find the code for the latest version on a GitHub repository.

Raspberry Pi 3 can now monitor vital health signs

Bengaluru-based hardware startup ProtoCentral has launched a multi-parameter patient monitoring add-on for Raspberry Pi 3. Called HealthyPi,